

Facebook-HTC to build Android Facebook phone?

If rumours are to be believed, Facebook is in contact with HTC to build its first official Facebook phone. The two giants are working together to bring out an Android-powered Facebook phone, codenamed Buffy. The plans are to run the phone on a modified version of Android that Facebook has tweaked heavily to deeply integrate its services, as well as to support HTML5 as a platform for applications. It is believed that Facebook chose HTC after also considering Samsung for the job.



Open source handheld video game system

This one is for the gaming freaks who want a powerful device that promises all kinds of games on one device. Gamegadget is an open source handheld video-game system that has been designed with the ultimate goal of playing any game on a single device, just as the iPod does for music lovers. Hundreds and thousands of games are being developed and currently 'archived', but not being enjoyed by gamers, thus giving no value to their developers and publishers. Gamegadget allows the owners of the game to re-market their back catalogue, in their original format, set the appropriate pricing, and gain incremental revenue with no additional investment.



World's first Android e-reader with Mirasol

Kyobo, in association with Qualcomm, has launched the world's first Android-based e-reader that uses a Mirasol colour e-paper display. Mirasol is the colour display technology from Qualcomm that promises colour, video-capable e-paper with battery life akin to monochrome e-ink screens. The e-reader has been priced at \$310, and goes on sale in South Korea from today. It targets education customers rather than prospective iPad buyers. The e-reader has a 14.5 cm (5.7 inch) capacitive touchscreen and runs Android 2.3 with a locked-down custom user interface on a 1 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon S2 processor. Kyobo will offer 90,000 books on the e-reader, along with video education content.

A new Linux logging system

In an attempt to replace the age old *syslog*, two Red Hat developers, Lennart Poettering and Kay Sievers, have developed a new Linux logging system. It is expected that the new Journal Daemon will provide a solution to the issues that came with *syslog*. *syslog* is the current industry standard for logging on *NIX systems and has been around for 30 years. Due to its simplicity and ubiquitousness, it is an invaluable tool for administrators. However, its limitations are substantial, and over time these have started to become serious problems. Developers have cited 14 issues, which have been

Google patents Android pattern unlock

Those who use Android smartphones must be familiar with Google's Android pattern on the home screen to unlock the phone. While unlocking a device, the screen on your smartphone shows nine dots in a grid. You need to connect the dots and draw a pattern to unlock the device, which has to be identical to the one you stored while locking. Google has now patented this pattern-unlock, along with other new gestures. Google was also granted another patent: 'Automatic Derivation of Analogous Touch Gestures From A User-Defined Gesture.'



Meet Romo—a headphone-controlled robot

Romotive has introduced Romo, a smartphone dock on a treaded chassis to help with its mobility. Romo is based on a simple concept: You put your smartphone into a clear chassis and load it up with apps, to get it rolling along on a pair of tank treads. Instead of relying on a dock connector to communicate between the phone and the chassis, Romo relies on the transmission of different audio frequencies through your phone's headphone jack. Both Android and iOS users can use Romo, without fiddling with adaptors or purchasing a chassis that would only be usable by a specific phone.



Romotive will soon release a series of apps to provide Romo with a variety of different functions. Since the Romo Kickstarter project wrapped up on November 21, 2011, you will be able to buy a Romo only when they go to market. But yes, you can also pre-order one. For now, the RomoRemote app can be downloaded from the iOS App Store for free.